

- **SECONDS DURATION** denotes the duration of the voice file that we want to extract.

The command below will extract the first 10 seconds from 'input.wav' and store it in 'output.wav'.

```
$ sox input.wav output.wav trim 0 10
```

—Selvageshan Sankaran,
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Dual copy/paste options in Linux

 Linux has a cool way to copy and paste on your desktop PC, using the mouse. You simply highlight what you want to copy with the left mouse button (click and drag to select), and then click the middle mouse button to paste. But did you know that this method works in addition to the traditional copy/paste command, which most of us are acquainted with, i.e., copying and pasting using the 'Ctrl+C' and 'Ctrl+V' commands?

This implies that you have two options to copy and paste, simultaneously. You can highlight section A and copy it with the standard 'Ctrl+C' method, and then highlight section B with the left mouse button using the drag/highlight method. Now, you have two different pieces of text to paste—one with the 'Ctrl+V' command and the other with the middle mouse button.

—Debapriya Biswas,
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Knowing the 'dd' command status

 We normally use the 'dd' command for a disk dump, during which we are not shown the status of the copy function in progress. So, here is a way to know how much of the copy function is completed or what the status of the 'dd' command is.

Sending a 'USR1' signal to a running 'dd' process makes it print I/O statistics to standard error and then resume copying.

```
$dd if=/dev/zero of=/dev/null & pid=$!
```

```
$kill -USR1 $pid; sleep 1; kill $pid
```

—Viral Mehta, viral.mehta@lntinfotech.com

Password protect single user mode

 Here is a simple tip that works on Red Hat Enterprise Linux and similar distros. This helps you to protect users from entering the single user mode without a root password.

To activate this, you need to make an entry into the 'inittab' file, as given below:

```
#vim /etc/inittab
```

```
su:S:wait:/sbin/sulogin
```

Now, save and exit 'vim'.

This will ask users to give the root password whenever they try to enter a single user mode.

—Vikash Kumar Jha, v4evervikash@gmail.com

Find your terminal's most used command

 This small clever piece of code lets you know the top 10 most-used commands on your shell.

```
cut -d\  -f 1 ~/.bash_history | sort | uniq -c | sort -rn |  
head -n 10 | sed 's/,/' &/g'
```

—Nitish Upreti, nitishupreti@gmail.com

Setting abbreviations in VI editor

There is a feature in the VI editor that allows you to define expansion values for abbreviations. This means that the moment a user types an abbreviation in the edit mode (for which its expansion has already been set), the editor generates its expansion.

An abbreviation can be defined in the command mode by giving the following 'EX' command:

```
:ab abbr full text
```

...where 'abbr' is an abbreviation for the specified phrase. The expansion is done only when the abbreviation is typed as a word. Avoid repeating the abbreviation in the defined phrase.

The abbreviation can be disabled by typing the following command:

```
:unab abbr
```

—S.Sathyananarayanan,
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END

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